

How do caterpillars turn into butterflies?

A caterpillar starts its life by hatching from an egg. The caterpillar feeds and grows, and then wraps its body inside a hard case called a pupa. Next, the caterpillar completely changes shape in a process called metamorphosis. Finally, it leaves the pupa as an adult butterfly with wings.

2

Hanging on

When fully grown, the caterpillar attaches itself to a twig using a silken thread. It sheds its skin again and its new skin hardens into a tough case, called a pupa or chrysalis.

1

Eating leaves

A caterpillar, or butterfly larva, hatches from an egg. It eats mostly leaves and quickly outgrows its skin, which it sheds several times.

3

Wrapping up

The pupa wraps around the caterpillar. Inside the pupa, the caterpillar's body starts to change shape.

Quick quiz



What do caterpillars eat?



What happens inside the chrysalis?



Where do butterflies lay eggs?

There are around **20,000** types of butterfly in the world.

